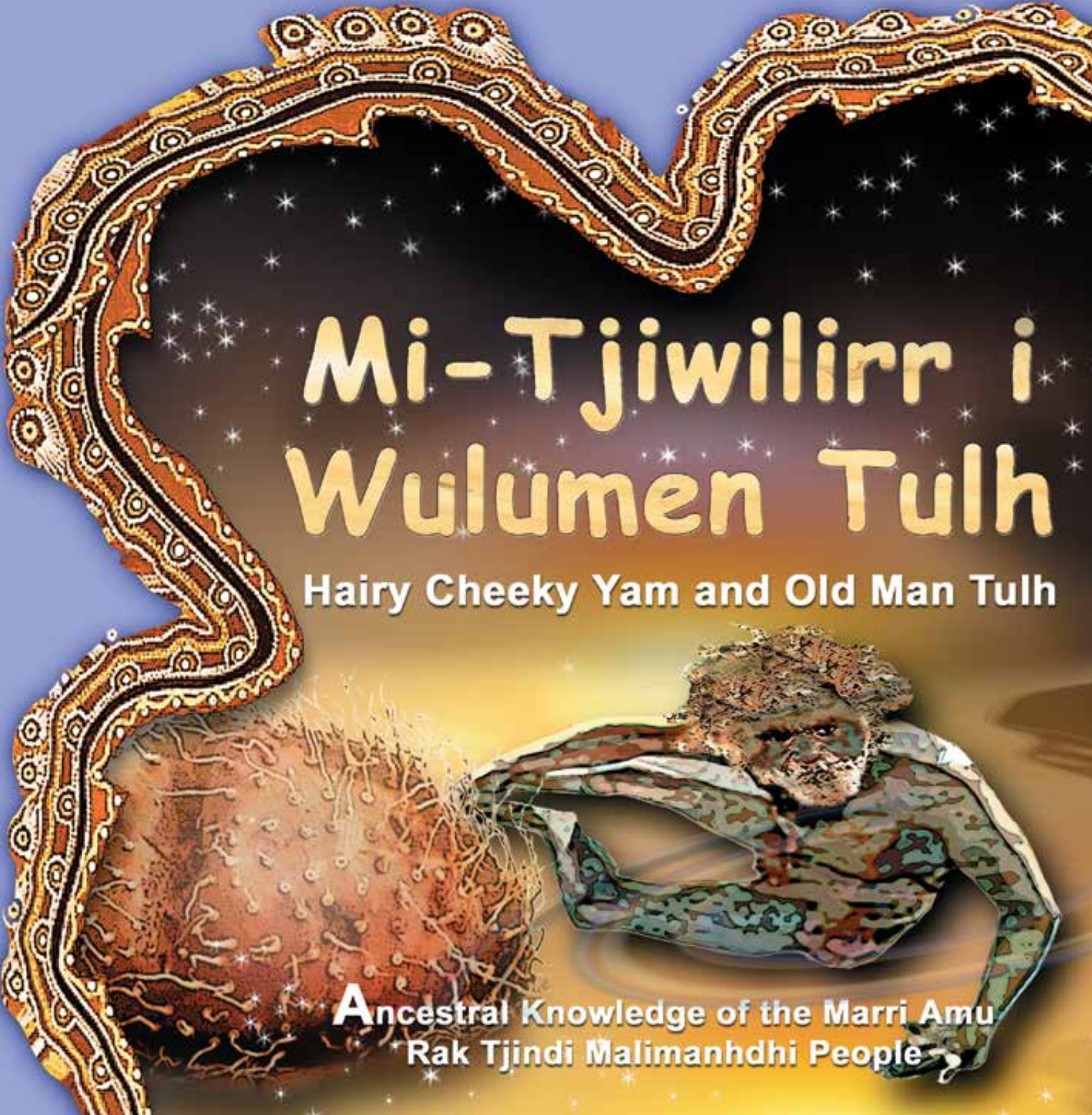
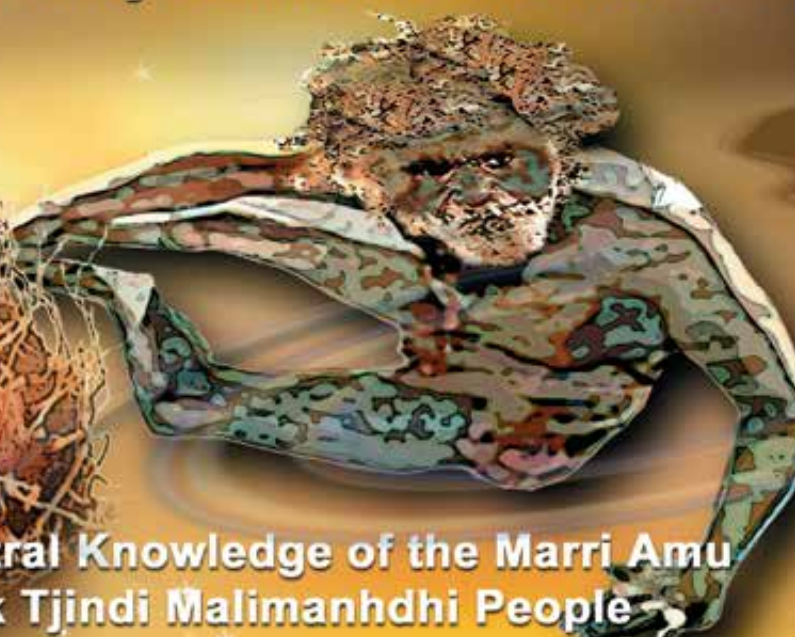




Mi-Tjiwilirr i Wulumen Tulh

Hairy Cheeky Yam and Old Man Tulh



Ancestral Knowledge of the Marri Amu
Rak Tjindi Malimanhdhi People

This book and accompanying audio recording contain pictures and voices of Marri Ngarr elders in the Northern Territory of Australia.

If someone shown in this book or singing on the audio tape has passed away, hearing their name or voice, or seeing their photo, may cause sadness and distress to some people.

Before using this book and audio tape, readers should talk to Indigenous Australian community members and take their advice about using these stories in the classroom, community or public forum.



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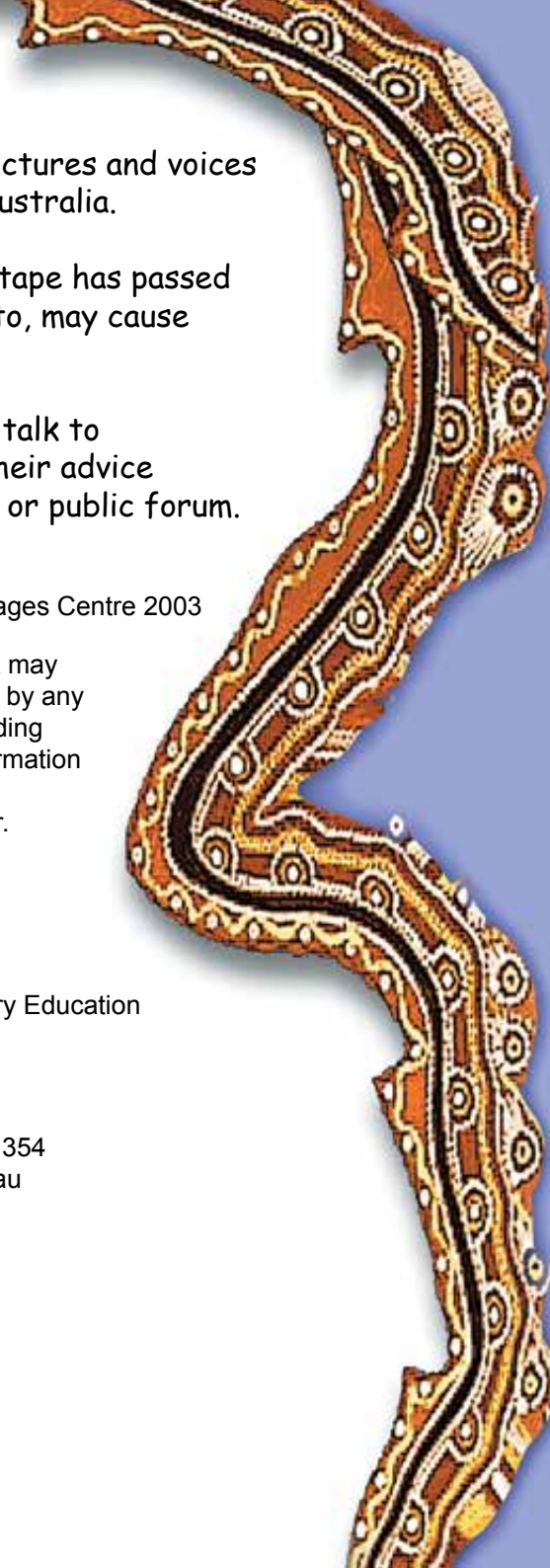
Published by Batchelor Press

Batchelor Institute of Indigenous Tertiary Education
Batchelor
Northern Territory 0845

Ph: (08) 89 397 352 Fax: (08) 89 397 354
Email: batchelorpress@batchelor.edu.au

ISBN: 0 7245 6029 7

ISBN (set) : 0 7245 6035 1



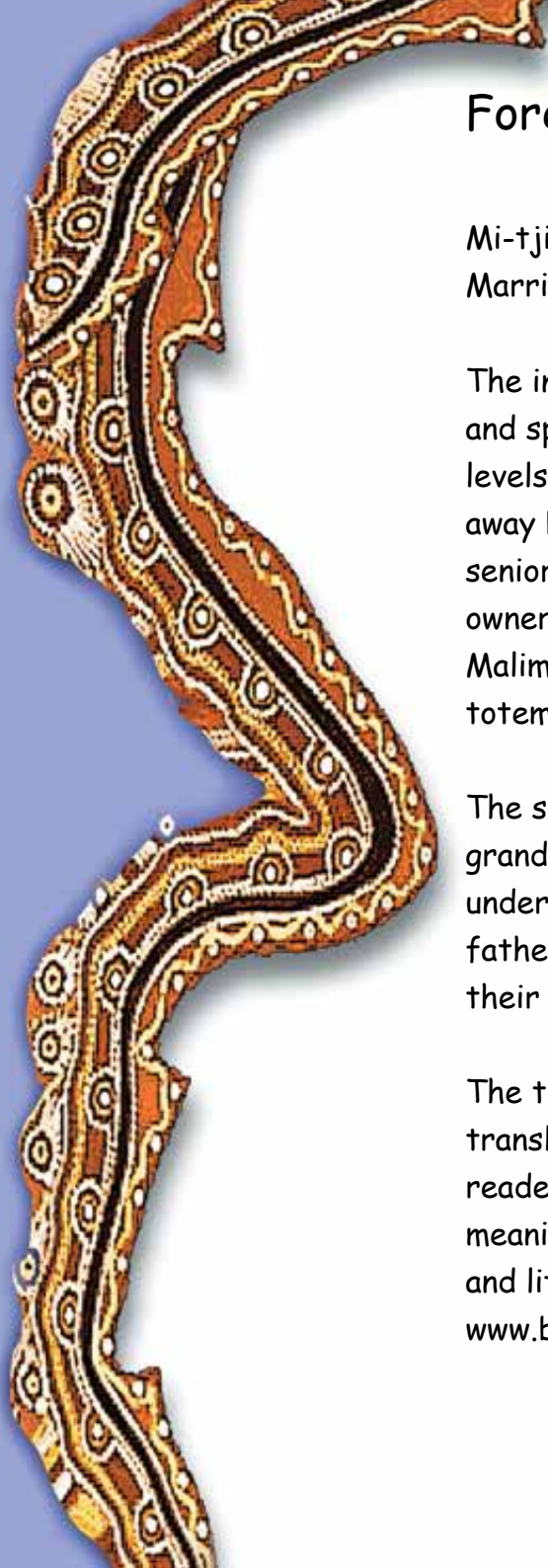
Foreword

Mi-tjiwilirr i wulumen Tulh is the ancestral knowledge of the Marri Amu Rak Tjindi Malimanhdhi peoples.

The information in this story relates directly to the law and spirituality of the Marri Amu people and carries many levels of meaning. Unfortunately the storyteller passed away before these books could be printed. He was the senior elder at the time of recording this story. However, ownership of the story belongs to all Marri Amu Rak Tjindi Malimanhdhi tribal members, as do the country, songs and totems described in the back of this book.

The stories are passed down to the children by their grandfathers and fathers. Later when the children know and understand about their country and ancestors from their fathers, they can learn about their mother's country from their grandmothers and mothers.

The translations in this book are not strictly direct translations, but are intended to allow English readers an understanding of the story's open meaning. Morpheme by morpheme glosses and literal translation can be located on www.batchelorpress.batchelor.edu.au.



Acknowledgements

Storyteller:	Yawa Edward Nemarluk
Language Custodians:	Tjakul Maurice Nilco, Malhima Marie Nilco
Language Advisor:	Alunga Les Kundjul
Linguists:	Dr Lysbeth Ford, Dittin Aloysius Kungul
Project Manager:	Maree Klesch
Project Officer:	Mark Crocombe
Illustrator:	Donna Williams-Sowter
Photographs:	Mark Crocombe
Audio Recording:	Mark Crocombe
Audio Editing:	Maree Klesch, Rob Lewis
Computer Assistance:	Br Vince Roche

Funded by:



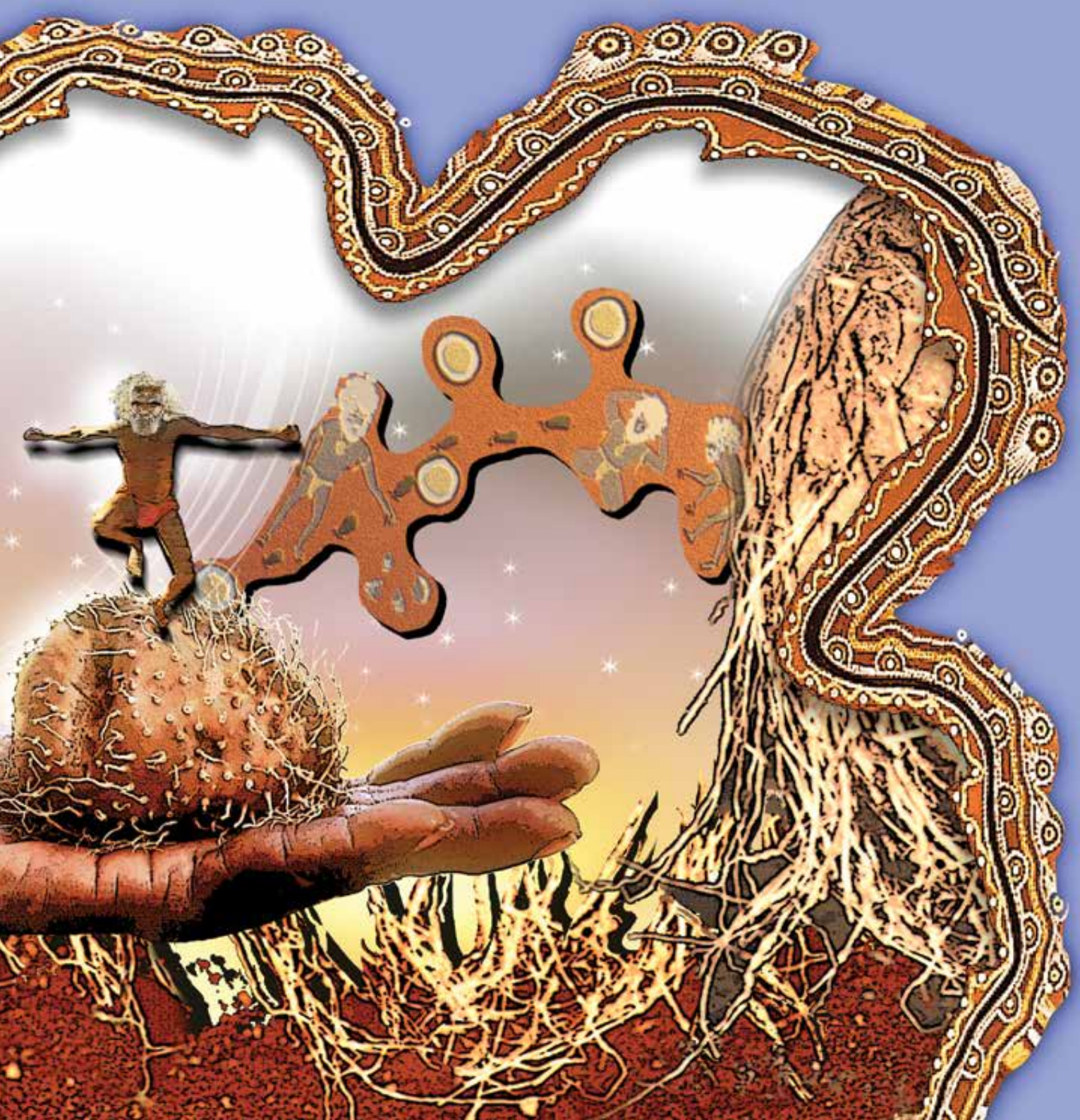


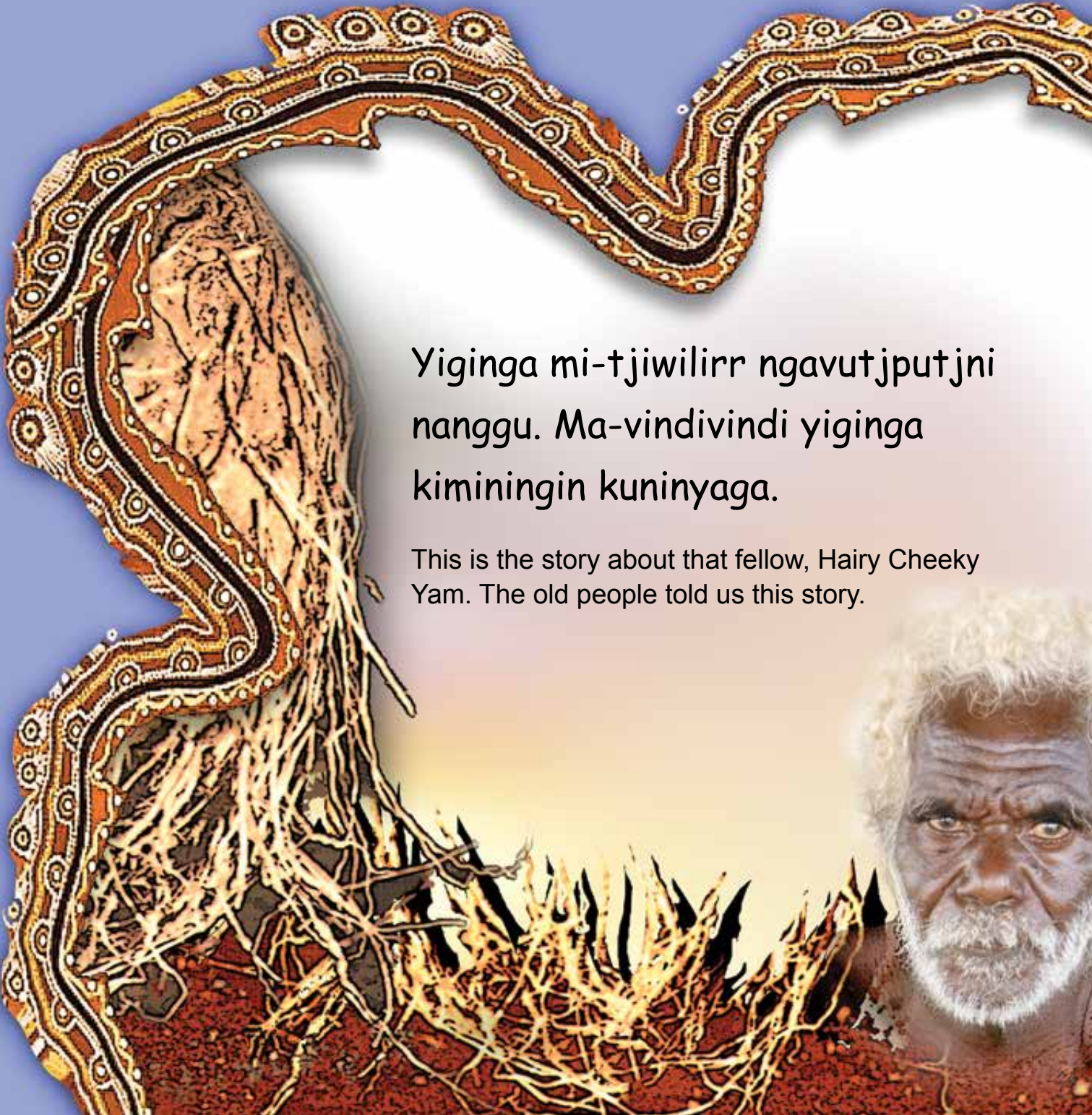
Mi-Tjiwilirr i Wulumen Tulh



Hairy Cheeky Yam and Old Man Tulh

Ancestral Knowledge of the
Marri Amu Rak Tjindi Malimanhdhi People

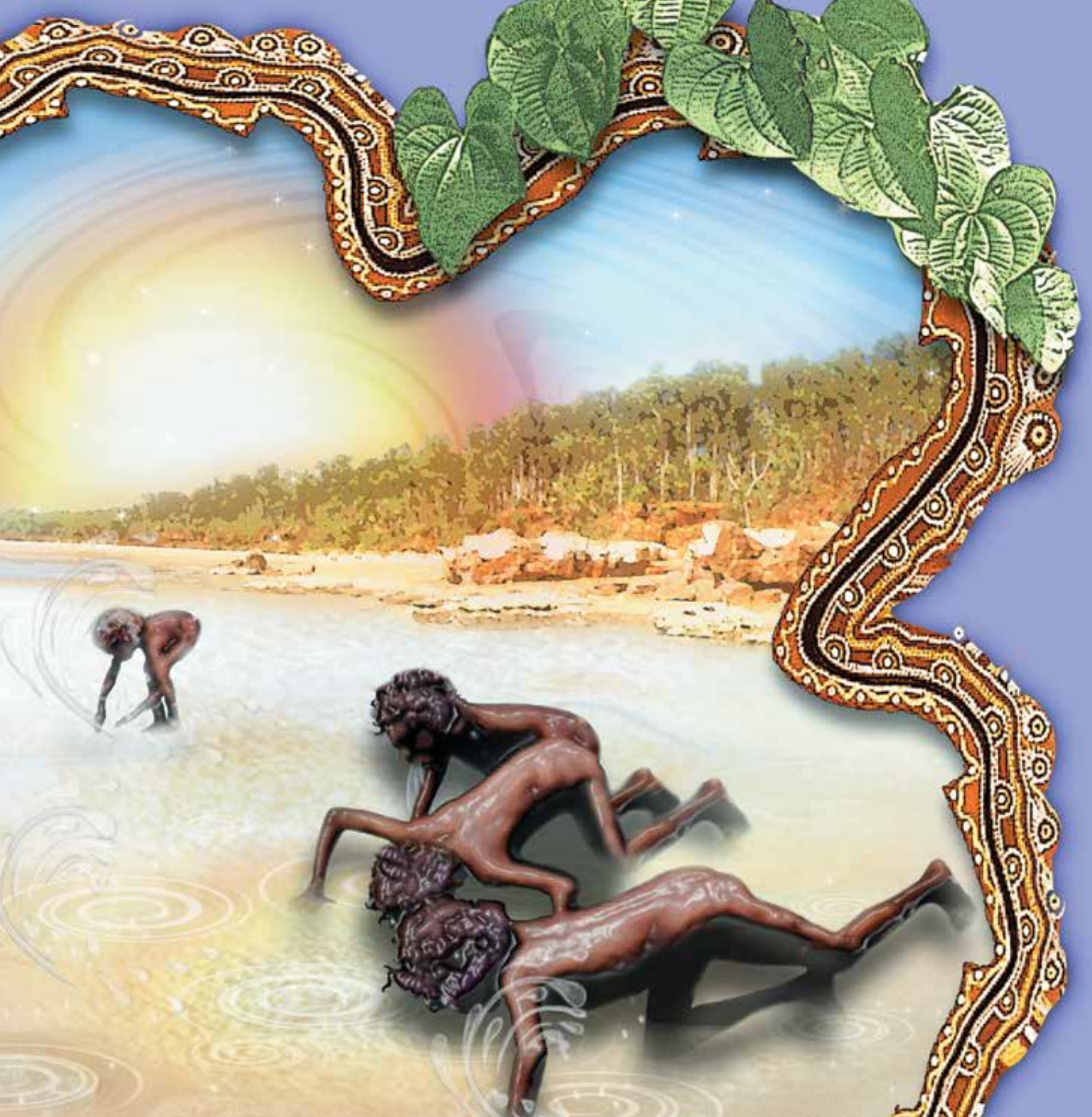


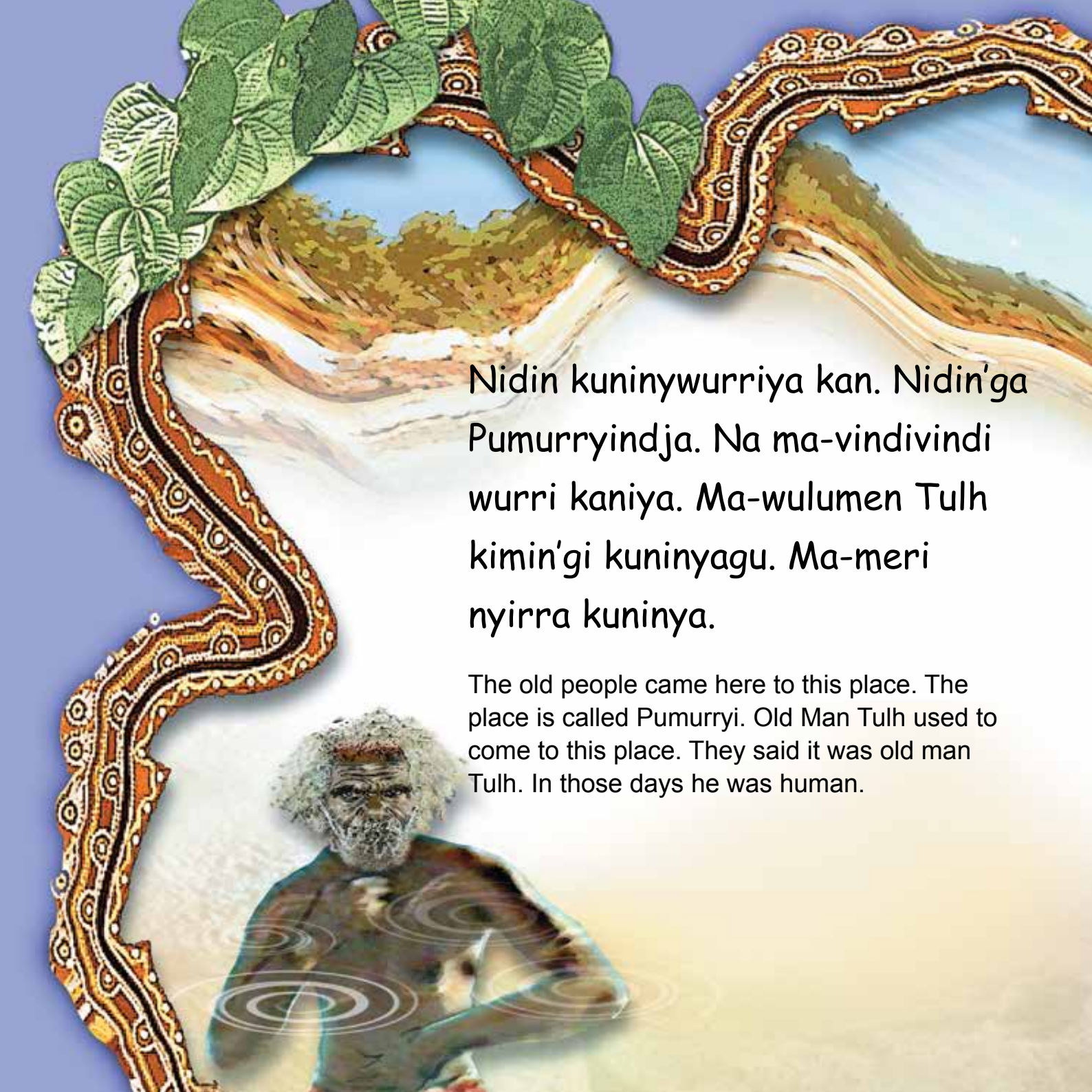


Yinginga mi-tjiwilirr ngavutjputjni
nangu. Ma-vindivindi yinginga
kiminingin kuninyaga.

This is the story about that fellow, Hairy Cheeky
Yam. The old people told us this story.

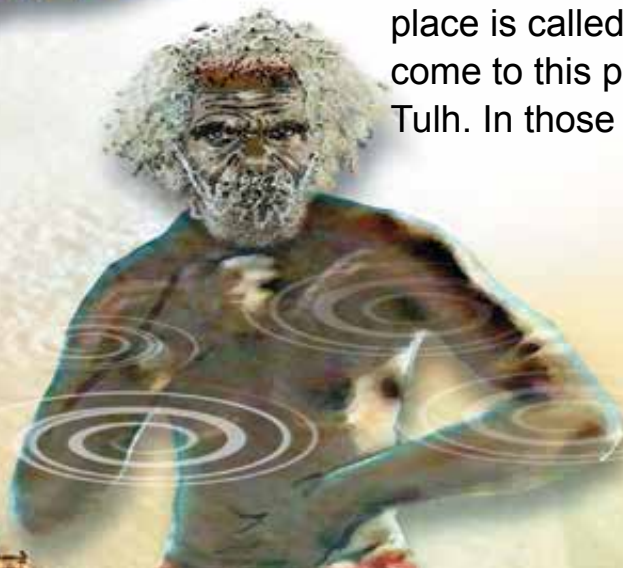




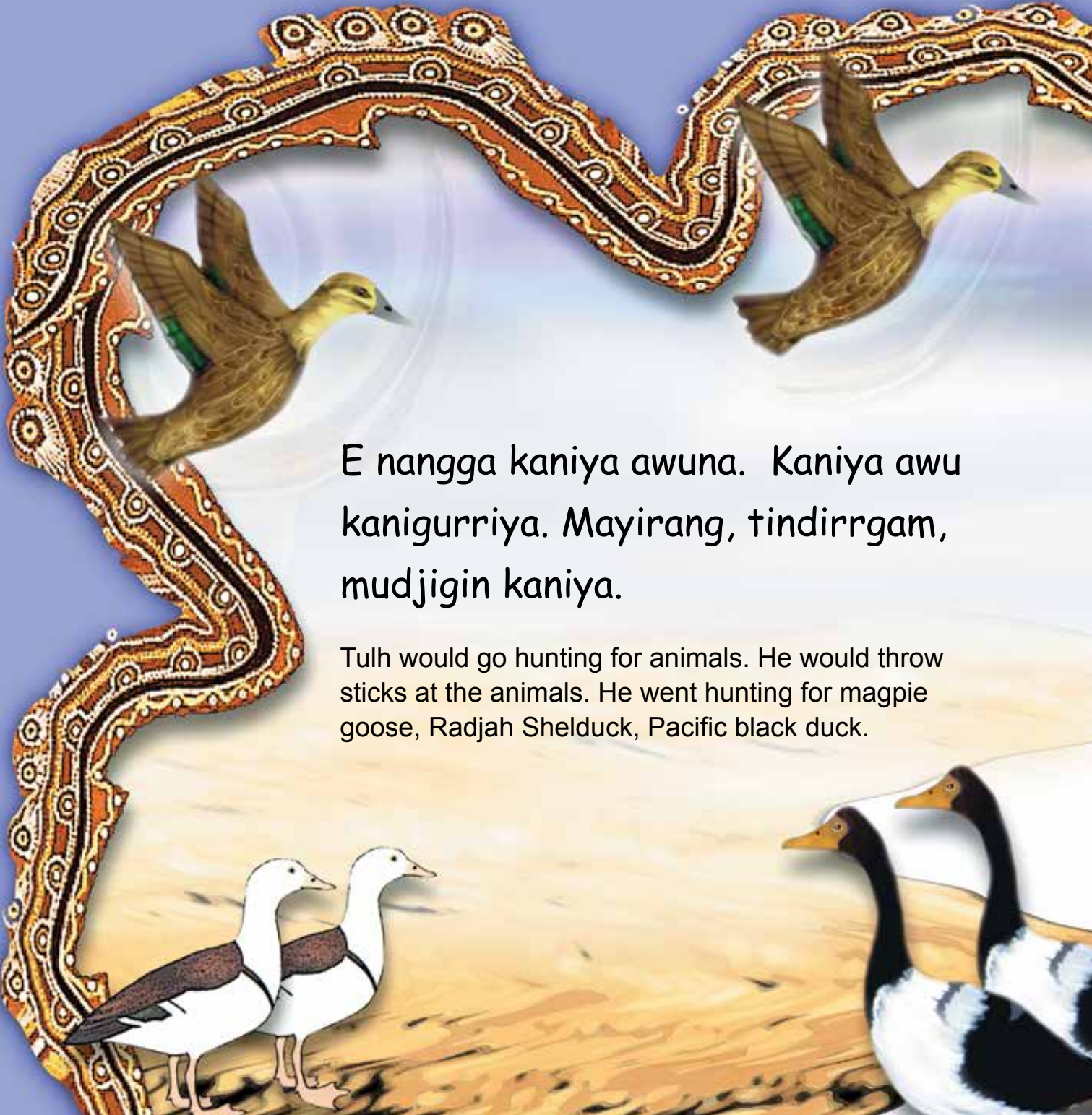


Nidin kuninywurriya kan. Nidin'ga
Pumurryindja. Na ma-vindivindi
wurri kaniya. Ma-wulumen Tulh
kimin'gi kuninyagu. Ma-meri
nyirra kuninya.

The old people came here to this place. The
place is called Pumurryi. Old Man Tulh used to
come to this place. They said it was old man
Tulh. In those days he was human.





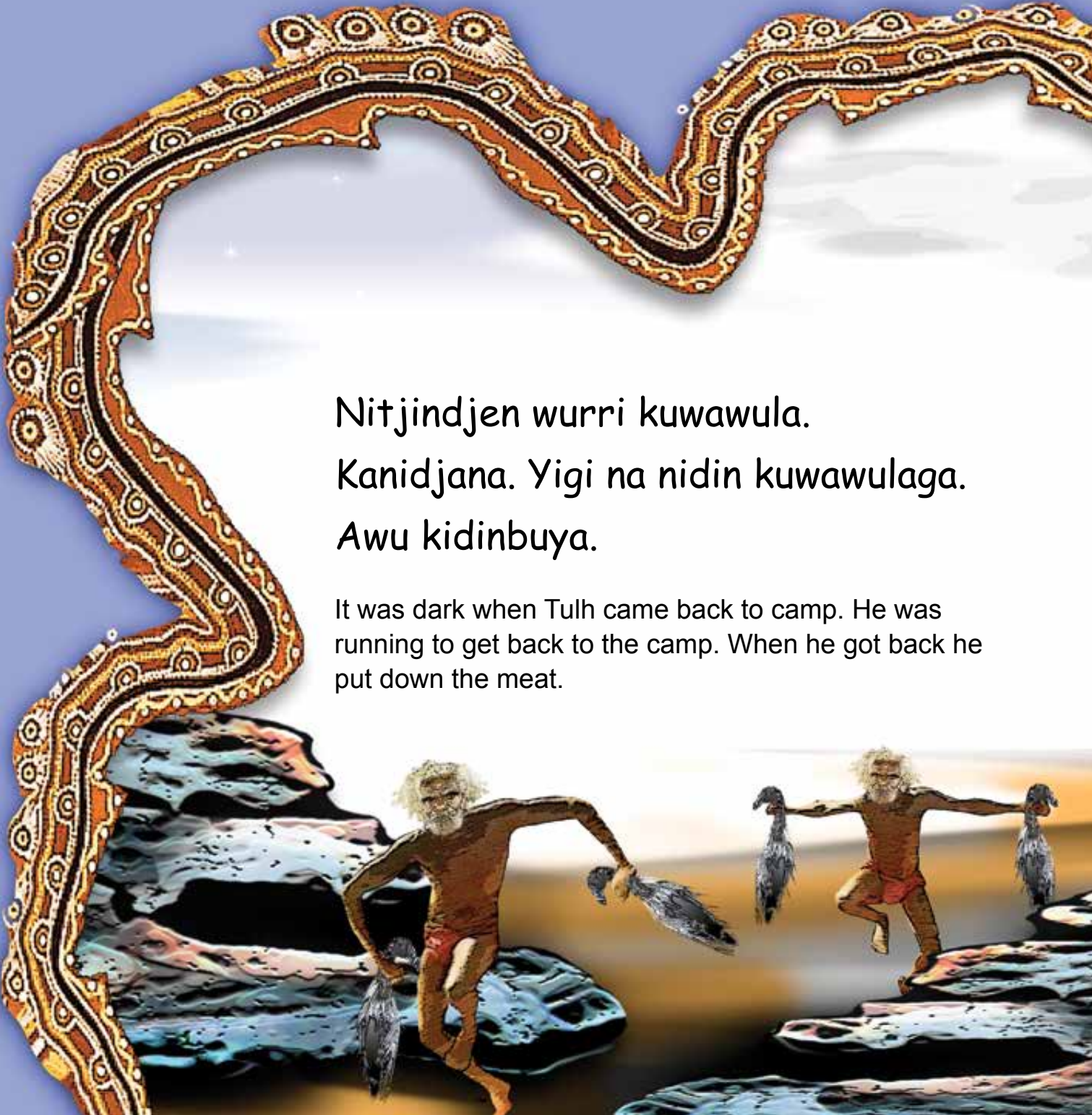


E nangga kaniya awuna. Kaniya awu
kanigurriya. Mayirang, tindirrgam,
mudjigin kaniya.

Tulh would go hunting for animals. He would throw
sticks at the animals. He went hunting for magpie
goose, Radjah Shelduck, Pacific black duck.







Nitjindjen wurri kuwawula.
Kanidjana. Yigi na nidin kuwawulaga.
Awu kidinbuya.

It was dark when Tulh came back to camp. He was running to get back to the camp. When he got back he put down the meat.

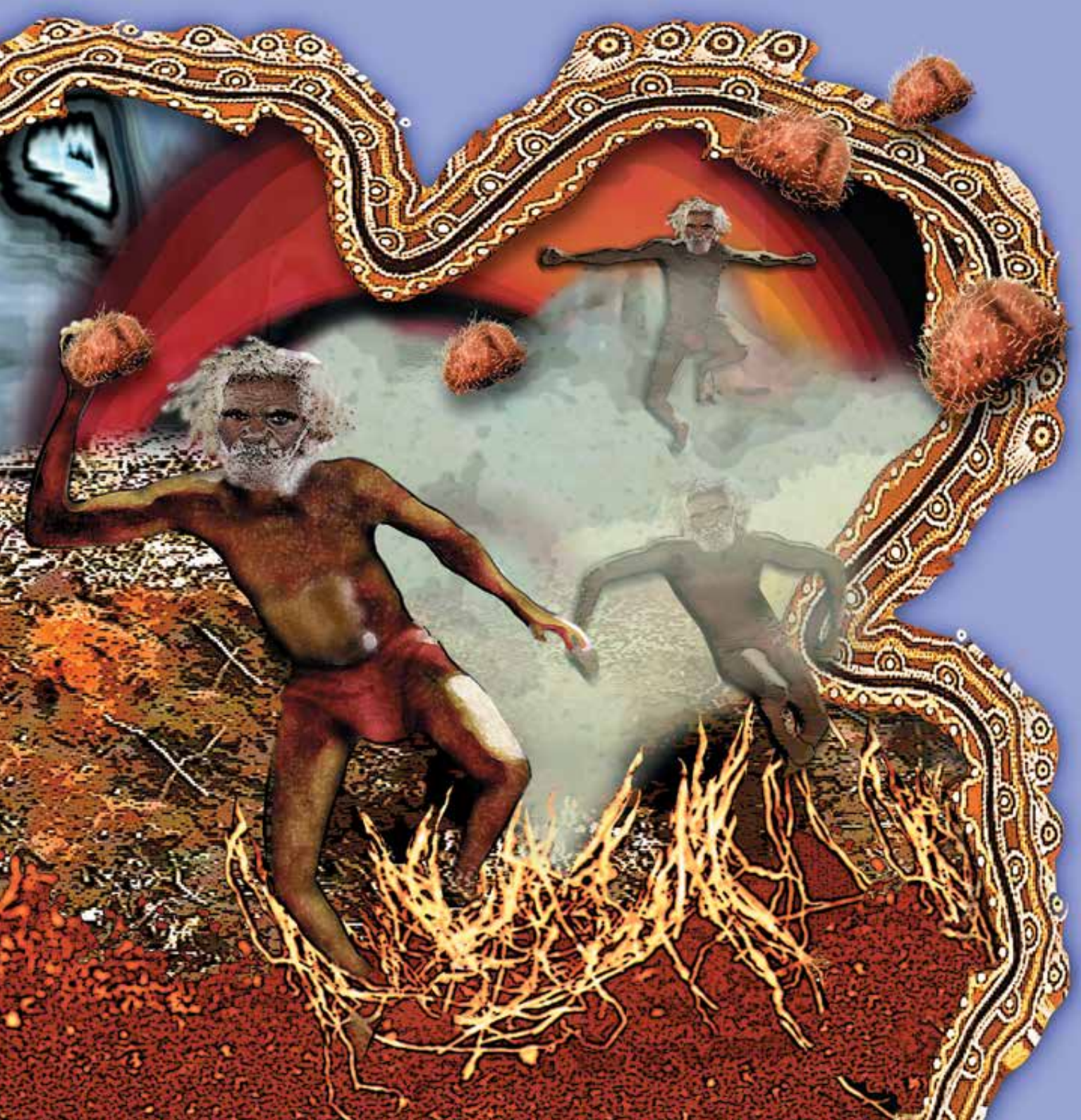






Nada miyindjeni miyindjeni nanggu
kinyinigulita mi-tjiwilirrdjeni.

He was hungry and he took a hairy cheeky yam
from the camp fire, but that hairy cheeky yam
wasn't cooked. He became really angry.





Nada nangga kuwabutjdjena.
Kuwabutj kaniya kandagin.

He threw the hairy cheeky yam away.
He kept throwing yams everywhere.



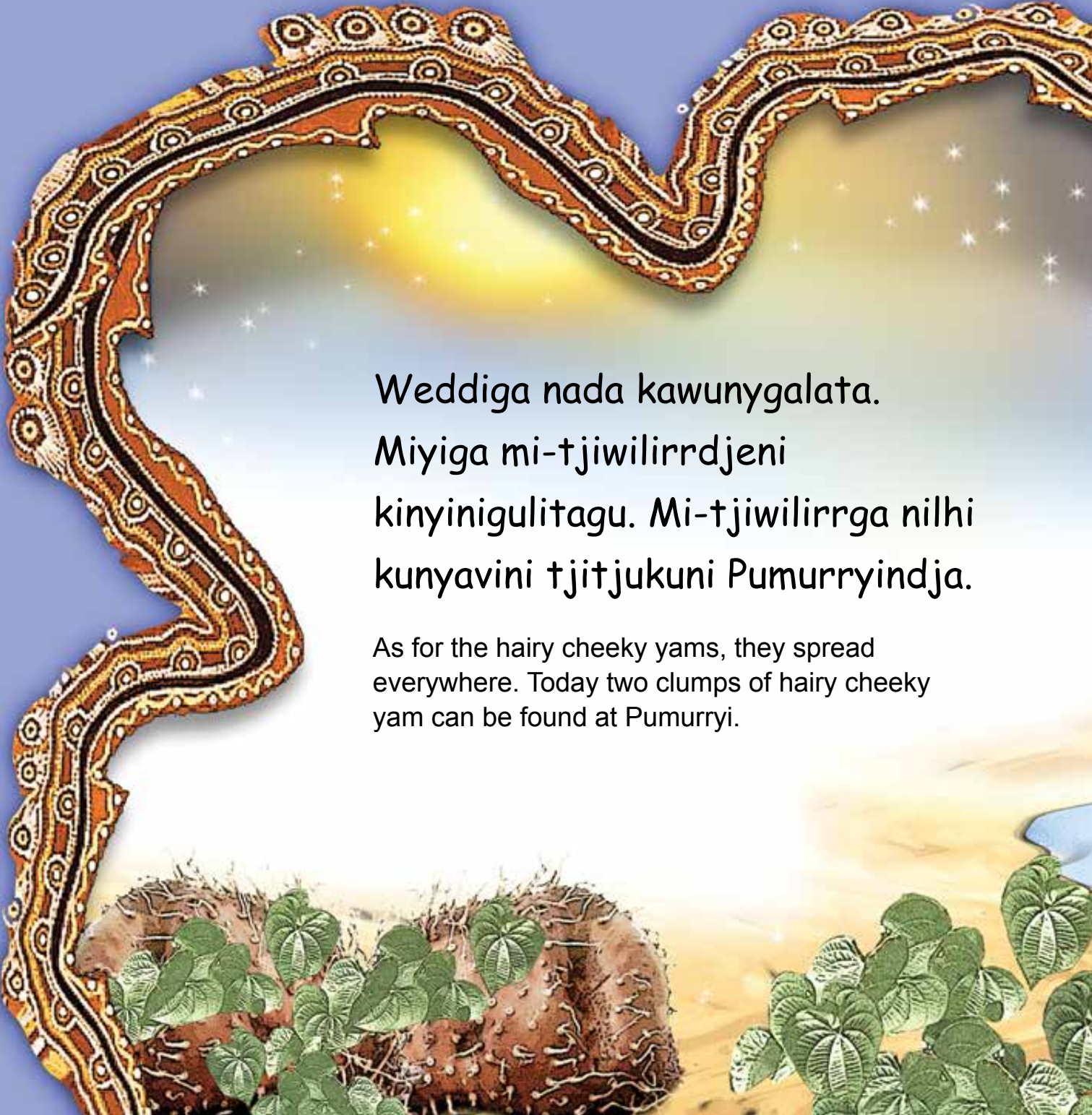


Nada kan'ga nangga kinyinigulitaga
kanukuta. Kanikuta yigindjendan.
Kurzindjen nidin na Tulh. Kagandja
kanidjeta.

Tulh was so angry with the tucker that he came down
to the beach. He came down to Tulh's place. He is
sitting down at his place.







Weddiga nada kawunygata.
Miyiga mi-tjiwilirrdjeni
kinyinigulitagu. Mi-tjiwilirrga nilhi
kunyavini tjitjukuni Pumurryindja.

As for the hairy cheeky yams, they spread
everywhere. Today two clumps of hairy cheeky
yam can be found at Pumurryi.





Nidin na Ngirindjendan na Tulh
ganidjeta nangu.

Tulh made his camp at Nidin.
He turned into that dreaming site.

Language Custodians

Yawa Edward Namarluk



Yawa Edward Namarluk recorded this story on tape some years ago. Sadly he passed away before the story could be translated and published. Yawa was born at Tjindi in about 1935 and lived there as a young child. When the community was at the Old Mission, only the men went to the mission for tea, sugar and tobacco. But when the mission moved to Port Keats, Yawa went to school there. Later in his teenage years he was at Channel Island. When he returned to Port Keats he married and worked as a gardener until moving to the outstation at Nadirri. Much later he started his own outstation at his homeland Tjindi.

Tjakul Maurice Nilco

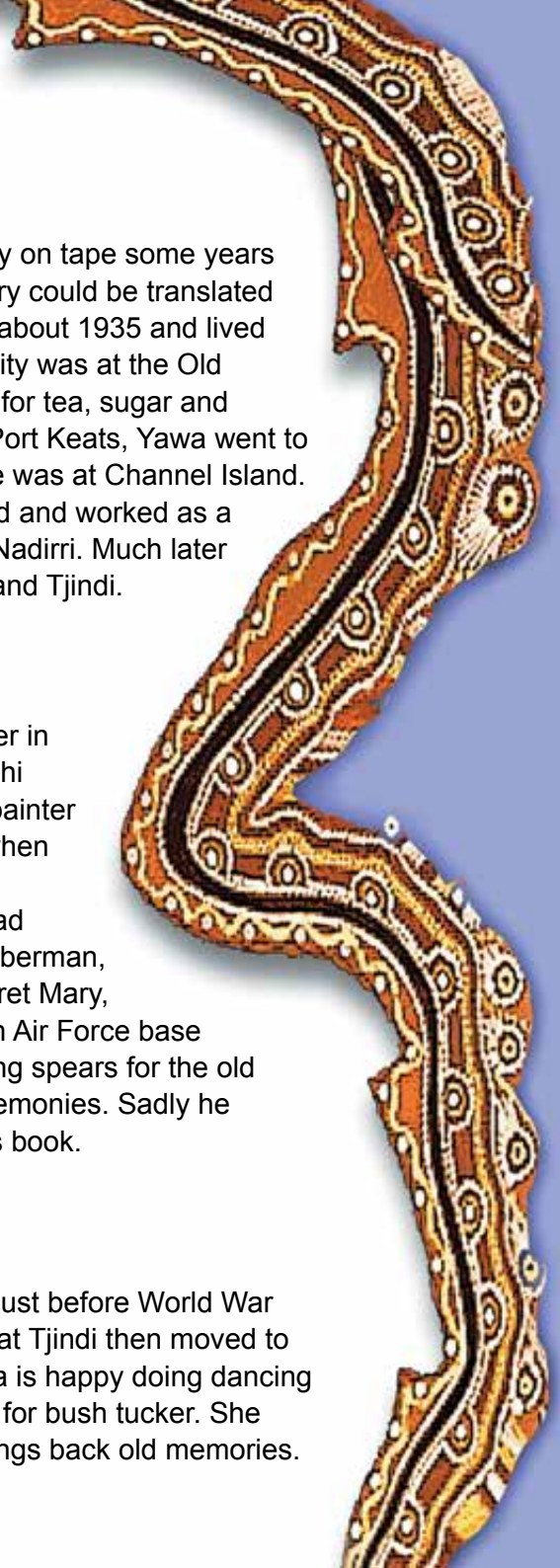


Tjakul was born at Tjindi on the Moyle River in about 1930. Tjakul's grandfather was Niwilhi Charlie Brinken Barbi who was a famous painter and songman. Tjakul was a young child when he came to live at Port Keats. During his working life he travelled the country and had many occupations including stockman, timberman, crocodile shooter, deckhand on the Margaret Mary, and he also worked at the Royal Australian Air Force base in Darwin. Tjakul was well known for making spears for the old people and his singing and dancing at ceremonies. Sadly he passed away during the preparation of this book.

Malhima Marie Nilco



Malhima was born at Yilyiliyen near Tjindi just before World War Two. When Malhima was young she lived at Tjindi then moved to Port Keats where she has stayed. Malhima is happy doing dancing for ceremonies, going hunting and looking for bush tucker. She likes to go camping at Tjindi because it brings back old memories.



Clan Artist

Tjinbili Anthony Namarluk



Tjinbili Anthony Namarluk was born at Wadeye. He worked as a health worker for some time before moving to the housing industry in repairs and maintenance. Tjinbili is a family man, minding his children while his wife Miriam is teaching at the school. He has been working part-time for the Wadeye Aboriginal Languages Centre. Tjinbili studied environmental health with Batchelor College and completed a Certificate in Environmental Health.

On completion of his studies he decided to concentrate on painting his dreamings. Tjinbili's paintings have been sent to America, Sydney and Melbourne.

The illustrations in this book contain elements from two of Tjinbili's paintings about mi-tjiwilirr i wulumen Tulh. The paintings, shown below, are acrylic on canvas and are currently housed in the Kanamkek-Yile Ngala museum at Wadeye.



Song Words

Verse 1

Wulumen kidinmititagu wulu Tulh
Wulumen kidinmitita Tulh
Miyigu kidin Tulh kisji
Wulumen Tulh kidinmitita kisji
Wulumen Tulh kidinmitita kisji
Miyiga tjiwilirr nal kisji
Kidinmititagu
Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu kisji
Wulumen Tulh kidinmitita kisji
Miyigu kidin nal kisji

Verse 2

Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu
Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu
Miyiga tjiwilirr nalh kisji
Kuwabutj kaniya
Kuwarn kisji
Wulumen Tulh kidinmitita
Miyigu tjiwilirr nal kisji
Wulumen Tulh kidinmitita
Miyigu tjiwilirr nal kisji
Kuwabutj kaniya
Kuwarn kisji
Kuwabutj kaniya
Kuwarn kisji

Verse 3

Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu
Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu
Miyigu kidinmititagu
Kuwabutj kaniyagu
Wulumen Tulh kuwabutj kaniyagu
Wulumen Tulh kuwabutj kaniyagu

Verse 4

Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu
Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu
Miyigu tjiwilirr nal kisji
Kidinmititagu
Kuwabutj nal kisji
Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu
Wulumen Tulh kidinmititagu
Miyigu tjiwilirr nal kisji
Kuwabutj kaniya
Kuwarn
Kuwarn kisji

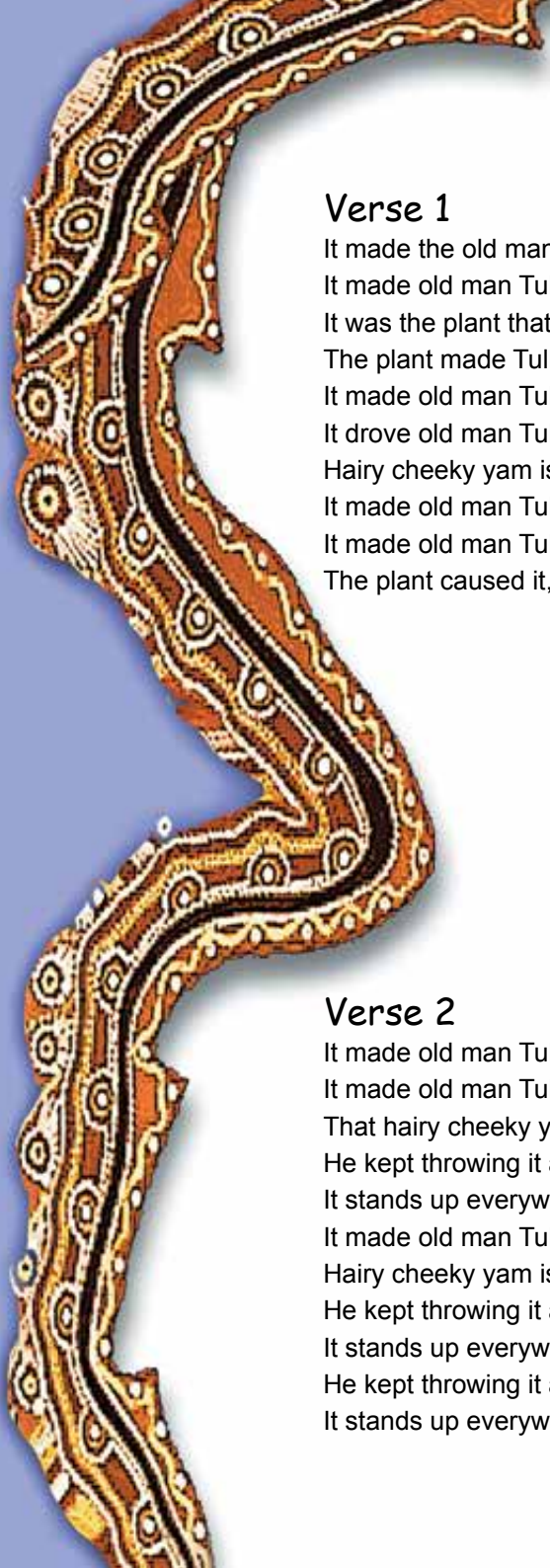
Wangga Songmen

Tjakul Maurice
Nilco

Pulda Ambrose
Piyalam

Alunga Les
Kundjil





Verse 1

It made the old man wild, old man Tulh.
It made old man Tulh wild.
It was the plant that made him wild.
The plant made Tulh wild, it was like that.
It made old man Tulh wild, it was like that.
It drove old man Tulh crazy, he was like that.
Hairy cheeky yam is just like that.
It made old man Tulh wild, it was like that.
It made old man Tulh wild, it was like that.
The plant caused it, it was just like that.

Verse 2

It made old man Tulh wild.
It made old man Tulh wild.
That hairy cheeky yam, it's just like that
He kept throwing it away
It stands up everywhere, like that.
It made old man Tulh wild.
Hairy cheeky yam is just like that.
He kept throwing it away.
It stands up everywhere, it's just like that.
He kept throwing it away.
It stands up everywhere, it's like that.

Verse 3

It made old man Tulh wild.
It made old man Tulh wild.
The tucker made him wild.
He kept throwing it away.
Old man Tulh kept throwing it away.
Old man Tulh kept throwing it away.

Verse 4

It made old man Tulh wild.
It made old man Tulh wild.
Hairy cheeky yam is just like that.
It made him wild.
He throws it away, it's just like that.
It made old man Tulh wild.
It made old man Tulh wild.
Hairy cheeky yam is just like that.
He kept throwing it away.
It stands everywhere.
It stands everywhere, it's just like that.

Marri Amu Rak Tjindi Malimanhdhi People and Country

The Tjindi dreaming site is located in the area north of the Moyle River mouth and south of Cape Scott. The story sites are located on the beach approximately 5km north of Cape Dombey and include a string of reefs that run approximately 3km to the north-west including the large reef Tjinbili on the north-west end.

Country

Pumurryi, Karri Ngindji, Tjindi

Totems

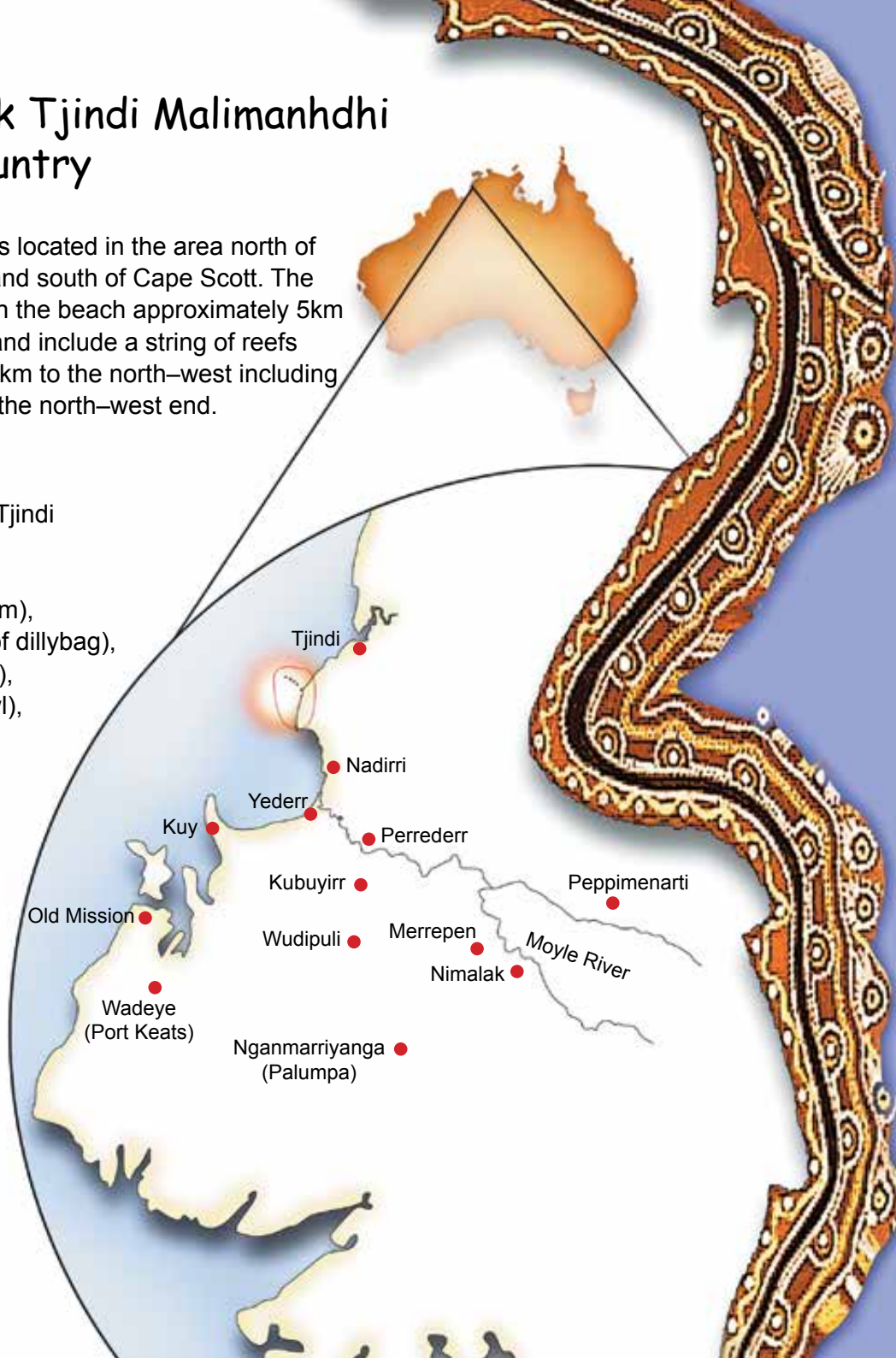
Tjiwilirr (hairy cheeky yam),
Thawurr pebel (handle of dillybag),
Warrgi (mangrove worm),
Malhimanyirr (jungle fowl),
Menggani (butterfly)

Clan

Rak Tjindi Malimanhdhi.
The families in this clan
are Barbi, Nemarluk,
Gumbaduck, Nama,
Nilco and Alliong.

Ceremonial group

Wangga





Marri Amu Word List

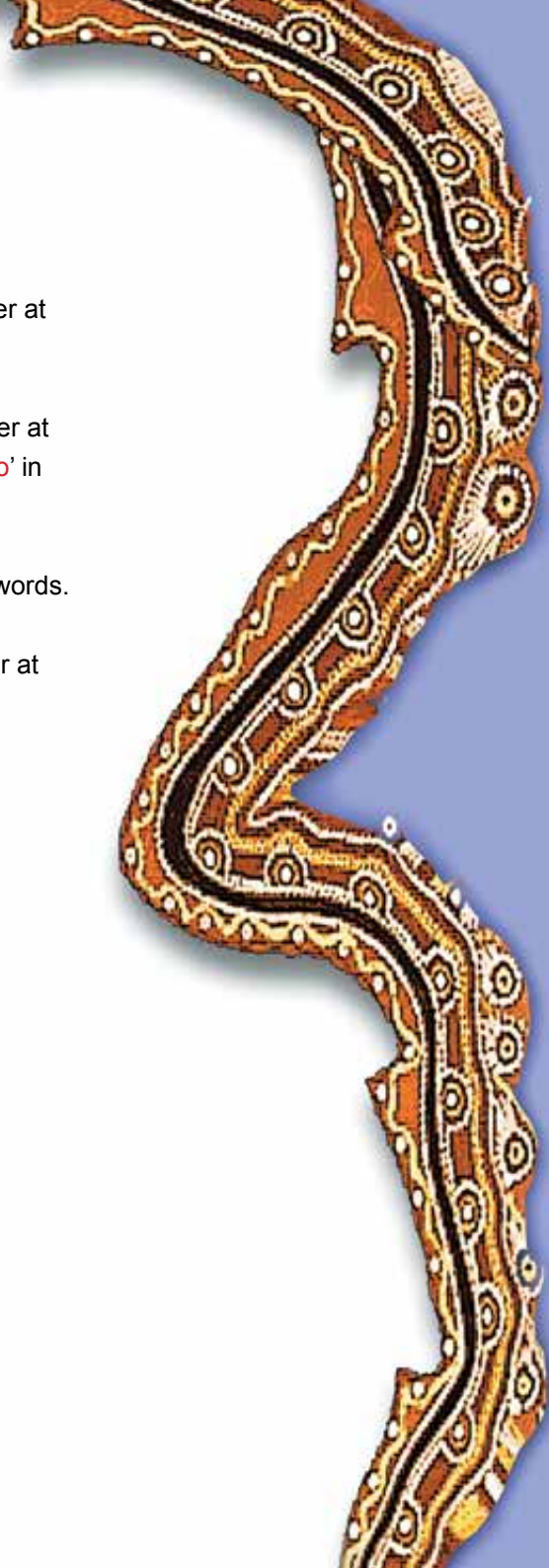
Marri Amu	English
ma-vindivindi	old people
ma-wulumen	old man
ma-meri	human(s)
thawurr	stick
wuyi	camp, place
awu	meat, animal(s)
kanidjana	s/he was running
kawunyivini	they sit down, stay
kuwa	s/he stands
kuwabutj	s/he throws away
yagatiya	dreaming place
munhirri.....	beach, sand
karrila.....	rock, stone
purangang	sea, ocean

Marri Amu Pronunciation

Vowel sounds and how to say them:

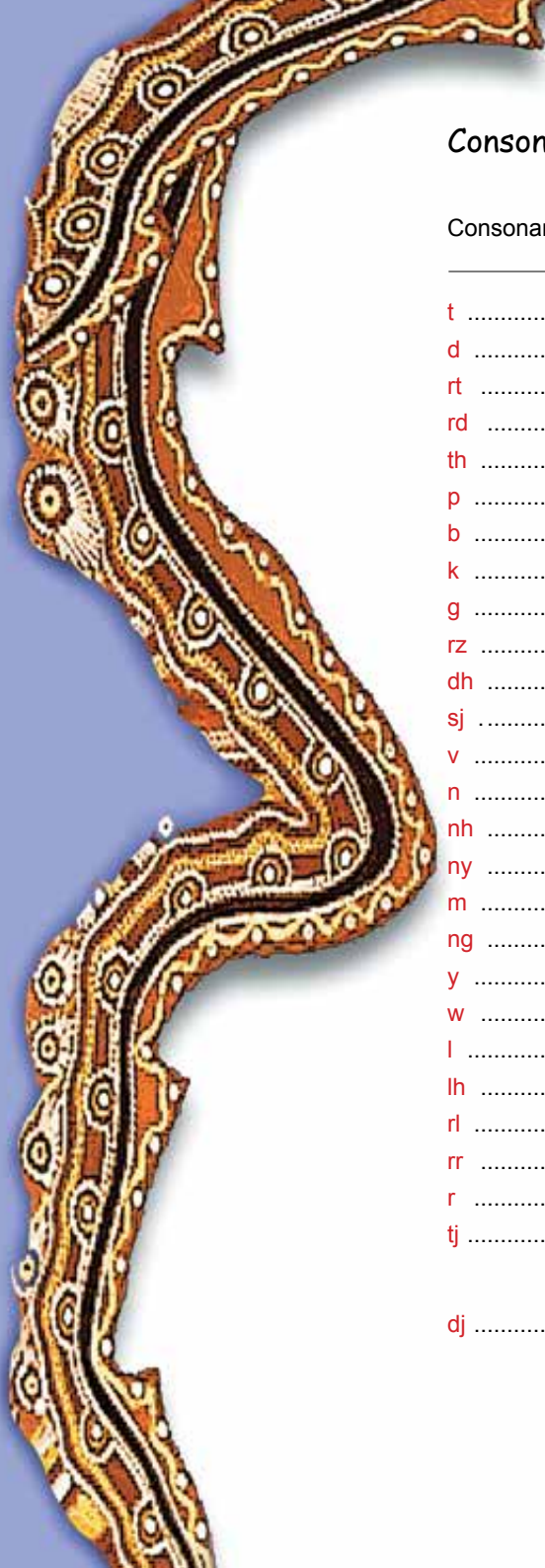
- i** high front vowel, can be found in the middle and end of words, never at the beginning of a word.
- u** high back vowel, can be found in the middle and end of words, never at the beginning of a word. In English it has the same sound as the 'oo' in wood, never as in English cut.
- a** low open vowel, can be found at the beginning, middle and end of words.
- e** mid front vowel, can be found in the middle and end of words, never at the beginning of a word.

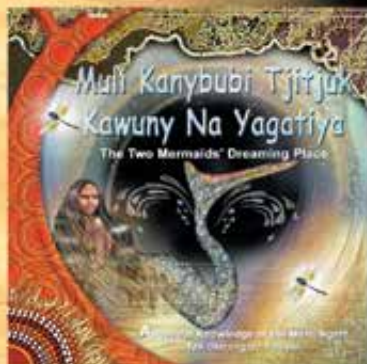
Vowel	Marri Amu	English
i middle	a-wiyerri 'mangrove mussel'	bit
i end	ma-meri 'man'	ski
u	wuvuvu 'cyclone'	wood
a	ma-yawa 'spirit'	happy
e	mi-merrepen 'sand palm'	met



Consonant sounds and how to say them:

Consonant	Marri Amu	English
t	tittil 'clapsticks'	mat
d	diyerri 'creek'	mad
rt	rte dimel 'seahorse'	-
rd	kanir dardal 'he's a singer'	-
th	thawurr 'tree'	-
p	purangang 'sea'	snap
b	bugam 'white'	rob
k	kurzi 's/he sits'	back
g	gati 'good'	gate
rz	kurzi 's/he sits'	-
dh	malidharr 'bandicoot'	this
sj	musjuling 'swag'	azure
v	daravu	very
n	nidin 'country'	nit
nh	munhirri 'sand'	-
ny	a-wanybi 'mudcrab'	onion
m	ma-meri 'man'	mama
ng	ngaka 'sister'	sing
y	wuy 'no'	yes
w	wurdi 'water'	way
l	tittil 'clapsticks'	lick
lh	malhima 'black plum'	-
rl	mi-wurli 'cheeky yam'	-
rr	marri 'language'	-
r	ringi 'cold season'	rib
tj	tjengi 'ear'	Like ch in peach, but flatten your tongue against the roof of your mouth
dj	a mudjigin 'black duck'	Like dg in nudge, but flatten your tongue against the roof of your mouth





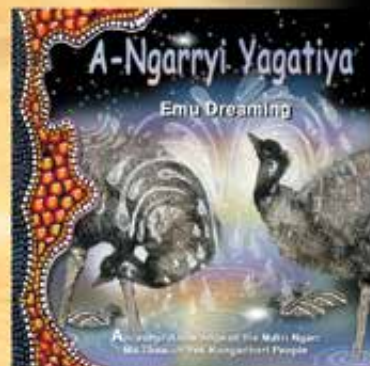
Muli Kanybubi Tjitjuk Kawuny Na Yagatiya

Muli Kanybubi Tjitjuk Kawuny Na Yagatiya is ancestral knowledge of the Marri Ngarr Yek Dirrangara people. The story describes the journey of two mermaids who travel from their dreaming site at Altjama across the Moyle River flood plains to Yederr and then return to Altjama.



Mi-Tjiwilirr i Wulumen Tulh

Mi-tjiwilirr i wulumen Tulh is ancestral knowledge of the Marri Amu Rak Tjindi Malimandhi people. The story tells about Old Man Tulh who comes back from hunting and is very hungry. He eats a cheeky yam that isn't cooked properly which makes him really angry. He runs down to the sea at Nidin and turns into a rock at that dreaming site.



A-Ngarryi Yagatiya

A-ngarryi yagatiya is ancestral knowledge of the Marri Ngarr Ma Thawurr Yek Kungarlbarl people. The story tells about a family of emus who travel across the country in search of food, finally making their dreaming site at Nganmarriyanga.



ISBN: 0 7245 6029 7

ISBN (set) : 0 7245 6035 1